

8 Great Autumn Slow Cooker Ideas

By: **Chaz Wilke** - Staff Writer

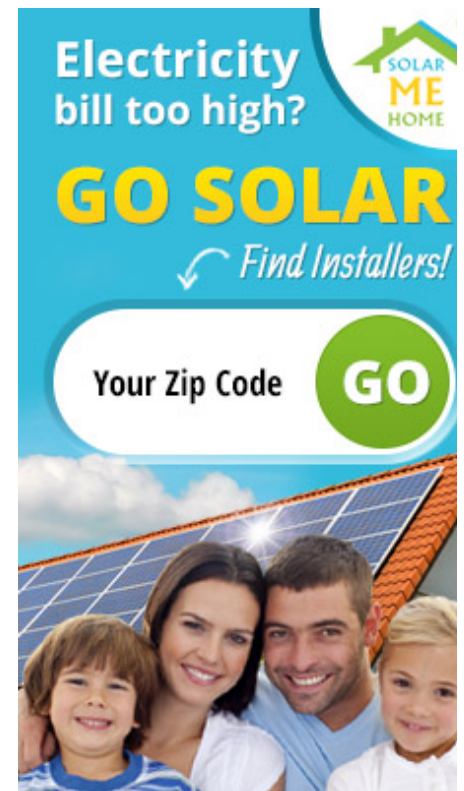


As the mercury retreats for a restful slumber this autumn, you might be looking for hearty and warm meal ideas to feed the family. No other kitchen appliance can fill that need better than a slow cooker.

Slow cookers offer the ease of unattended cooking and simple preparation that go hand in hand with spontaneous pickup games of football out on the lawn. Many slow cooker recipes generally require nothing more than throwing all the ingredients into the pot and the occasional stir. Cooking times for these meals can often sound extreme, but you can always prepare a slow cooker meal the night before and leave it on low as you sleep.

The smell of your creation will fill the house and beckon all in your home to come to the kitchen for a whiff of that tasty meal in the making.

Stews



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Few things perfectly complement the cooling autumn nights like a hearty stew slowly cooking all afternoon long. Stews are the great jazz songs of the food world. It's hard to mess one up and it can include nearly any ingredient.

Wondering what might be the difference between a soup and a stew? Well, the answer is the amount of broth. You'd never consider serving soup on a plate, but with some stews you actually can! A stew is a dense collection of more solid foods, and the liquid can be poured over the dish like gravy.

Crockpot Irish Stew

Ireland has more than its fair share of gloomy and brisk weather, so the Irish are familiar with hearty, body-warming meals! This beautiful stew includes two pounds of beef and a bevy of vegetables that get good and tender during the slow cooking process. Family Fresh Meals delivers the details on how to prepare this mouthwatering stew, click [here](http://bit.ly/1Jli0b7) (<http://bit.ly/1Jli0b7>) for the full recipe.

Slow Cooker Chicken Stew

It can get easy to assume that all slow cooker stews contain beef. It does seem that the majority of stew recipes use beef, but there are others out there that use any number of different ingredients. Like this chicken stew from food.com.

Just 14 simple ingredients make up this hearty and broth-heavy stew. One quick glance at the grocery list for this sumptuous slow cooker meal will make your mouth water. See for yourself by clicking [here](http://fd.cm/1FbiLbI) (<http://fd.cm/1FbiLbI>) for the full recipe.

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You might have given up on rice dishes ever since Aunt Gertrude served you some underwhelming rice pilaf at Thanksgiving that one year. But rice dishes have the flexibility to become some incredible slow cooker meals. From Cajun spice to savory shrimp, rice is able to fortify a ranges of meals into a hearty autumn dish.

Bubba's Jambalaya

With a name that forces a creole accent just by pronouncing it, Jambalaya is a spicy, meaty and endlessly satisfying slow cooker dish. There are a number of fantastic recipes out there, but here's one that includes the secret ingredient missing from all the rest: Bacon.

Bubba's Jambalaya remembers the importance of simmering your vegetables in bacon fat. That might sound gross but it's the secret to getting every bite to burst with that savory flavor. Head over to allrecipes.com or click [here](http://bit.ly/1WdRWlf) (<http://bit.ly/1WdRWlf>) for the full recipe.

Slow Cooker Shrimp and Artichoke Barley Risotto

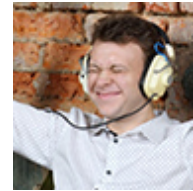
This Italian dish includes a few of the same ingredients as the jambalaya but the end result tastes very different. If you're a pescatarian, this is the recipe for you! With a lobster base and shrimps aplenty, this risotto is hearty enough to stand as its own meal, not just a paltry side dish. Click [here](http://bit.ly/1V66Vks) (<http://bit.ly/1V66Vks>) for the grocery list and prep instructions!

Drinks



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The beauty of serving warm drinks in a slow cooker during a gathering is just how lovely it can make your home smell. The two drinks below both benefit from whole cinnamon sticks thrown in for good measure. Those sticks will emit a lovely seasonal aroma as long as you keep your slow cooker on low.

Mulled Wine

Red wine that's left to stew with spices, cinnamon sticks and citrus is considered Mulled Wine. Thank the ancient Romans for this fun fall idea. This recipe includes adding some apple cider along with the wine, orange peel and full cinnamon sticks. A few other spices round out the simple recipe. Click [here](http://bit.ly/1LrPvyr) (<http://bit.ly/1LrPvyr>) for a seasonally appropriate libation!

Hot Apple Cider

Even simpler to make than mulled wine, hot apple cider can often be bought pre-made. Throw a jug of that in your slow cooker with a couple of sticks of cinnamon and in a few hours, your entire home will smell incredible! You'll also have a great drink ready to be sipped out on the porch as you enjoy the changing autumn colors.

Desserts

To round out your slow cooker recipe quiver, here are two sumptuous desert ideas.

Poached Pears in Caramel Sauce

Not every dessert needs to be dripping in fudge. This simple recipe takes the natural sugars of the pear and helps it along with adding an addicting caramel sauce. Late summer through fall is the harvest season for pears, so great fruit will be dirt cheap these next few months. Stock up and devour this delectable treat! Check out the recipe [here](http://bit.ly/1YvQt1O) (<http://bit.ly/1YvQt1O>).

Gooey Chocolate Cake

And to think, you may have gone your whole life thinking that baking a cake in a slow cooker was impossible. Well, we're here to inform you that you can in fact bake a cake in your common slow cooker.

As long as you spray your slow cooker with nonstick cooking spray, all you need to do is add the ingredients, mix and let your creation cook on low for four hours! After that you will have an irresistible desert treat! Click [here](http://bit.ly/1MmqaVa) (<http://bit.ly/1MmqaVa>) for the full recipe.

Takeaway

The fall is a perfect time to spend the weekend at home with friends and family. Enjoy the changing season and dust off your slow cooker for some hearty and warm meals and treats!

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